George O. Smith, I remember, catching us alone, semi-amused us with a long disquisition on the advantages of masturbation over other forms of sexual activity.

I met Edward E. "Doc" Smith for the first time. From the late 1920s and through the 1930s right up to the rise of Heinlein, Doc Smith was the most towering figure in science fiction, thanks to the enormous scope of his novels. He was the first, in his story "The Skylark of Space," to deal with interstellar flight, as opposed to mere interplanetary ventures. He was a gray-haired, fatherly figure, fifty-seven at the time, and very popular, even though it was well recognized that he was no longer at the growing edge of the field.

There was also present Lloyd Eshbach, who was a science-fiction book publisher. He had a small publishing firm that put out limited editions of scienne-fiction favorites. The editions did not make very much money, but to have magazine science fiction in book form was an awe-inspiring thing. He told me he would like to publish the Foundation series in book form. I said I was perfectly willing—but nothing ever came of it. 1

After dinner, Meisel and I went out to the de Camps and stayed the evening. Catherine was her usual endearingly voluble self, and managed to tell us that she had posed in the nude for Bob Heinlein (with Leslyn present, of course) and, when she described the pose, I suddenly remembered the pictures I had seen in Campbell's place 5^2 years before.

I said, in energetic astonishment, "Was that you?"

"Why, yes," she said.

And Sprague, with his own gift for understatement, lifted his eyebrows and said mildly to Catherine, "My dear, you get an F for discretion."

Whenever I try to think of Sprague at his most characteristic, and

1 1 heard later that the convention voted for "favorite author" and I finished in eleventh place. Henry Kuttner was in first place.

his most lovable, it is that moment that comes back—the raised eyebrows and the look of mild rebuke.